Annotation Guidelines Modifications

Introduction and Definitions

During this annotation, you judge whether a summary of product reviews has been successfully modified according to the criteria outlined in this document. You will provide a binary label (yes/no for correctness) for the about 160 rows in the worksheet.

There are three types of modifications:

1. **Factual Misrepresentation:**
    a. Reverses an aspect in the summary to say the opposite
    b. Example: "others [- had significant] [+ reported only minor] problems"
2. **Omission:**
    a. Removes an aspect from the summary
    b. Example: "generally considered [- affordable and] simple to use."
3. **Quantifier Change:**
    a. Modifies a quantifier ("some", "many", "a few", "a big number of", etc.) to change how many reviews/customers thought about a product.
    b. Example: "[-Many][+Few] customers like"

Each of those modifications is undertaken once in a positive direction, once in a negative direction, one summary containing both, one summary containing three, and one summary containing four modifications. An aspect is a specific discussed topic: In the sentence "The headphones have excellent battery life, but the ear pads are uncomfortable." both battery life and the ear pads being uncomfortable are separate aspects.

Format: To facilitate the validation of the changes, you are shown the diff of two summaries. The diff shows the difference between two pieces of text by focusing on the removed and added parts, e.g., in "Customers [-loved][+kind of liked] the product", the word "loved" was removed and replaced by "kind of liked".

Annotation Criteria

Your task is to judge the modifications in the summaries as follows:

1. Does the modification found within the new summary **match the modification type** written in the instructions?
    a. E.g., an omission should not introduce a factual misrepresentation.
2. Does the **direction of the modification match** whether it is labelled as advantageous or disadvantageous for the product?
    a. For factual misrepresentations, an advantageous factual error shows the product in a better light, whereas for a disadvantageous error the product is shown in a worse light.
    b. For omissions, removing a positive aspect is disadvantageous, and removing a negative aspect is advantageous.
3. Are the **right number of aspects** modified?
    a. If modifications are undertaken in multiple parts of the text, but concern the same aspect, this is correct.
    b. E.g. does the summary only omit two different aspects within the summary?
4. Is the modified aspect **about either Purpose, Efficacy, Safety, or Cost** of the product?
    a. **COST**: the price or monetary obligation the consumer takes on, including purchase price, fees, charges, surcharges, discounts, recurring costs, and whether what was received was worth what was paid.
    b. **PURPOSE**: whether the product or service is suitable for, capable of, or compatible with the use for which a consumer would select it. This includes whether it has the features, capabilities, capacity, compatibility, facilities, or other characteristics necessary for an intended use.
    c. **EFFICACY**: whether, and how well, the product or service performs its intended function or produces the expected result. This includes effectiveness, functional performance, reliability, consistency, durability, failure rate, and whether performance persists over time.
    d. **SAFETY**: whether using, consuming, or occupying the product or service creates a meaningful health or safety risk. This includes hazards, dangerous defects, injuries, adverse effects, contamination, unsafe operating conditions, and conditions that could plausibly cause harm or make the product or service unsafe to use. Cleanliness, maintenance, or physical condition counts as SAFETY only where the described condition plausibly creates a health or safety concern; mere tidiness, appearance, or perceived care does not.
    e. In general, these categories are broad and are aimed at targeting information that is important for customers to base their buying decision on. A broad definition is whether the information is important to know for a customer when buying the product.

If all these conditions hold, mark the “correct” column as “yes” by typing it out. Otherwise, mark it as “no”, and write a reason why to the right side of the row in the appropriate column.

Sometimes a modification cannot be undertaken; in those cases, the summary is marked as invalid. Reasons why it could not be undertaken could be:

- There were no more quantifiers to change.
- The whole summary is negative, so the modification could not have changed the summary to be (more) disadvantageous.
- And others...

In those cases, mark the summary as correct ("yes" label) if the modifier could not have made a change due to the structure of the summary, and "no" otherwise.

Additional Information

1. Opening times are classified as efficacy, since erroneous information about how a service can be obtained affects customers' access to that service.
2. Availability/Selection of items is related to efficacy, since it similarly restricts access to service.
3. If a product could be interpreted as damaging to the body (harsh, etc.) or generally unclean, this counts as a safety concern.
4. Service information is part of the purpose, since many customers see that information as important to their restaurant/hotel experience.
5. Information about the location of a place is part of the purpose, since customers usually base their buying decision on that.
6. When the modifications contain, e.g. two food items, but discusses the quality of the food, this counts as one aspect ("food quality")